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Diego Huerta

Contact Information

Department of Economics
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Academic Positions

Assistant Professor, University of Chile, Department of Economics 2024-

Education

Ph.D., Economics, Northwestern University 2019-2024
Committee: Giorgio Primiceri (co-chair), Georgy Egorov (co-chair), Lawrence Christiano
M.Sc. in Economics (highest honors), University of Chile 2014
B.Sc. in Industrial Engineering (highest honors), University of Chile 2014

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Political Economy

Teaching Experience

Lecturer, Graduate, University of Chile
- Macroeconomics I 2026-
- Heterogeneous Agent Models 2025-

Lecturer, Undergraduate, University of Chile
- Macroeconomics I 2025-

Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate, Northwestern University
- Political Economics, Bruno Strulovici 2023
- Macroeconomics, Robert Gordon, Giorgio Primiceri, Larry Christiano 2021, 2022
- Introduction to Macroeconomics 2020, 2021

Teaching Assistant, Graduate, Pontifical Catholic University of Chile
- Heterogeneous Agents in Macroeconomics 2017, 2018

Teaching Assistant, Graduate, University of Chile
- Heterogeneous Agents in Macroeconomics 2016, 2017
- Labor Economics 2014
- Econometrics 2013, 2014

Lecturer, Graduate, Diego Portales University
- Empirical Industrial Organization, Master in Economics 2014

Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate, University of Chile
- Industrial Organization 2013
- Macroeconomics 2013
- Microeconomics 2011
- Introduction to Calculus 2010

Other Employment

Research Assistant, Professor Silvia Vannutelli, Northwestern University 2024
Research Assistant, Economic Research Department, Central Bank of Chile 2014-2019

Professional Activities

Seminar and Conference Presentations

2026 (scheduled): 38th European Association of Labour Economists Conference (EALE); Seminars at Pontifical Catholic University of Chile and Diego Portales University.

2025: XXI Ridge Political Economy Workshop; 31st Conference on Computing in Economics and Finance; Eleventh Conference of the Society for the Study of Economic Inequality (ECINEQ); 2025 RCEA International Conference in Economics, Econometrics, and Finance (ICEEF2025); Latin American and Caribbean Conference (LACEA); Annual Meeting of the Chilean Economic Society (SECHI); Seminar at the Central Bank of Chile.

2024: 23rd Annual Society for the Advancement of Economic Theory (SAET) Conference; Society of Economic Dynamics (SED); Annual Workshop Millennium Nucleus on the Evolution of Work (MNEW); Latin American and Caribbean Conference (LACEA); Annual Meeting of the Chilean Economic Society (SECHI); seminars at Northwestern University, the Kellogg School of Management, University of Chile, and Pontifical Catholic University of Chile.

2023: Northwestern University Macro Lunch seminar; Strategy Department Brown Bag Talks, Kellogg School of Management.

2022: Northwestern University Macro Lunch seminar.

2021: Northwestern University Macro Lunch seminar.

2017: Latin American and Caribbean Conference (LACEA); Annual Meeting of the Chilean Economic Society (SECHI); Seminar at the Central Bank of Chile; Mini-Workshop on Industrial Organization & Economic Theory, Complex Engineering Systems Institute (ISCI).

2016: Seminar at the Central Bank of Chile; Annual Meeting of the Chilean Economic Society (SECHI); Mini-Workshop on Industrial Organization & Economic Theory, Complex Engineering Systems Institute (ISCI).

2015: Seminar at the Central Bank of Chile; Annual Meeting of the Chilean Economic Society (SECHI).

2014: Seminar of the Central Bank of Chile; Mini-Workshop on Industrial Organization & Economic Theory, Complex Engineering Systems Institute (ISCI)

Editorial Service

Assistant Editor of the Journal of Economía Chilena (The Chilean Economy)	2018
Editor of the Working Papers of the Central Bank of Chile	2015–2017
Editor of the Economic Policy Papers of the Central Bank of Chile	2015–2017
Editor of the Studies in Economics Statistics of the Central Bank of Chile	2015–2017

Fellowships & Awards

FONDECYT Iniciación Grant, ANID–FONDECYT–11260307	2026
Research Projects Grant 2025, FEN, University of Chile	2025
Distinguished Teaching Assistant Award, Northwestern University	2022–2023
Northwestern University Fellowship	2019–2023
Research Grant. Complex Engineering Systems Institute (ISCI), University of Chile	2014
Scholarship for Master's Degree. National Commission for Scientific and Technological Research (CONICYT), Government of Chile	2013–2014

Publications

The Regressive Effects of Worker Protection: The Role of Financial Constraints (link)
Labour Economics, 100, 2026, 102892

Wealth Inequality and the Political Economy of Financial and Labour Regulations (link)
with Ronald Fischer
Journal of Public Economics, 204, 2021, 104553

The Inequality-Credit Nexus (link)
with Ronald Fischer and Patricio Valenzuela
Journal of International Money and Finance, 91, 2019, pp. 105–125

Working Papers

The Evolution of the Welfare State (JMP) (pdf)

The Political Economy of Labor Policy (*submitted*) (pdf)

Work in Progress

The Political Economy of Health

Policy-Making: Disentangling Politics from Economics

Welfare Analysis: Unraveling the Role of Transition Dynamics in Heterogeneous Agent Models
with Matias Bayas-Erazo

Languages

English (fluent), Spanish (native), Portuguese (fluent)

Programming

Matlab, Fortran, Julia, Stata